E1 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 8: Asking questions – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to choose the right question word, put the words of a question in order, and ask two sensible questions after a partner's talk. Task 2 requires those two questions, and many Entry 1 learners can answer far better than they can ask.

Materials: Handout E1-8A, one per learner. Five large question word cards: *What, Where, When, Who, How many*. The word strips from section B of the handout cut up, one set per pair, each question in its own envelope.

Activity 1: Five question words (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Stick the five question word cards across the board. Under each, draw a simple picture: a box for *What*, a house for *Where*, a clock for *When*, a face for *Who*, the numbers 1 2 3 for *How many*.
2. Say an answer. Learners point to the card that asks for it: "In Hackney." "On Monday." "My sister." "Rice." "Three." "At seven o'clock." "My teacher." "A pen." "Ten." "In the kitchen."
3. Drill the five words. Then say the answer and learners call the word aloud instead of pointing.
4. Give each of five learners a card. Say an answer; the learner holding the right card stands up and says the word.
5. Learners match the question words to the answers in section A of the handout.

Activity 2: Build the question (25 minutes)

1. Board the pattern in three boxes: *question word / do you / action*. Fill it: *Where / do you / live?* Drill. Change one box at a time: *When do you get up? What do you like?*
2. Show the second pattern without a question word: *Do you / like tea?* The answer is yes or no.
3. Show the two questions that are different because they use *is* and *are*: *What is your name? Where are you from?* Learners already know these by heart. Leave them on the board in a separate box.
4. Give each pair an envelope with one question cut into words. They build it, say it, and pass it on. Continue until every pair has built all six.
5. Learners write the six questions in section B of the handout.

Activity 3: What is the question? (20 minutes)

1. Say an answer about yourself: "I live in Leyton." Ask the class for the question. Do four more.
2. Learners write the questions for the four answers in section C of the handout, alone.
3. Check in pairs, then on the board. Accept *When do you get up?* and *What time do you get up?*
4. Pairs test each other: one says a true answer about themselves; the other asks the question it belongs to.

Activity 4: Two questions after a talk (25 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Remind learners: in the exam, the partner talks, then you ask two questions.
2. Give a five-sentence talk about your free time. The class listens. Then show the question starters in section D and ask learners to choose one and ask you.
3. Teach the safe route: listen for one thing the partner likes or does, then ask *Where…?* or *When…?* or *Do you like…?* about it.
4. Pairs: A gives the five-sentence talk from Lesson 2 or Lesson 5. B asks two questions from section D. A answers. Swap.
5. Change partners and repeat. This time B may not look at the handout.

Activity 5: Guess the card (25 minutes)

1. Use the food and free time cards from Lesson 7. One learner takes a card and hides it.

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2. The class asks yes/no questions to find it: “Is it food? Do you drink it? Is it hot? Do you like it?” Board useful questions as they come up.
3. Play three rounds as a class, then in groups of four.
4. Finish with a question race. Say a question word; pairs have 20 seconds to say a full question with it. The fastest correct pair gets a point.
5. Close: the class asks you five questions, one with each question word.

Answer key, Lesson 8

- **Section A:** 1 C, 2 A, 3 D, 4 B, 5 E.
- **Section B:** 1 Where do you live? 2 Do you like football? 3 What is your name? 4 When do you get up? 5 Where are you from? 6 Who do you live with?
- **Section C:** 1 Where do you live? 2 Do you like tea? 3 When do you get up? or What time do you get up? 4 Who do you live with?

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